

IVAN STRAHOF

Department of Applied Economics, University of Minnesota – Twin Cities
317H Ruttan Hall, 1994 Buford Ave., St. Paul, MN 55108
strahof@umn.edu | ivanstrahof.com | linkedin.com/in/ivanstrahof

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Applied Economics

University of Minnesota – Twin Cities

Dissertation Committee: Drs. Elizabeth Davis (primary adviser),

Jason Kerwin, Paul Glewwe, Deborah Levison

Primary Field: Trade and Development

Expected May 2027

Candidate Status: January 2025

B.A. Economics and Asian Studies

Bard College, Annandale-on-Hudson, NY

Adviser: Sanjaya DeSilva

May 2018

PAPERS IN PROGRESS

Why Don't You Just Meet Me in the Middle: Intrahousehold Bargaining and Divorce Reform in Mexico

Job Market Paper

This paper investigates how Mexico's adoption of no-fault unilateral divorce shifted intrahousehold resource shares among married couples using national expenditure survey data and staggered difference-in-differences. Couples with children reallocated an additional 9.3 percentage points of their budget from their own consumption toward children (5.7 points per child). The shift was largest among couples for whom divorce was predicted to be most likely, and the spouse less likely to file covered a larger share of the transfer.

Getting Busy at Home: Remote Work and Fertility

I estimate the effect of remote work on births using American Community Survey microdata and a local shift-share instrument. Exposure to remote work lowers the overall probability of a birth occurring. The decline is concentrated in higher-order births while first births rise modestly.

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant, IPUMS

June 2021 – Present

Institute for Social Research and Data Innovation, University of Minnesota

Internal and External Communication

- Respond to user inquiries across all IPUMS data collections over email, on a public forum, and through virtual drop-in office hour sessions. Inquiries primarily focus on identification of data and documentation errors and analytical best practices.
- Assisted data reporters with analyses later published in news outlets such as the *Washington Post*, *Wall Street Journal*, Bloomberg, *Business Insider*, CBS, *Los Angeles Times*, *Philadelphia Inquirer*, and *Miami Herald*.

Product Review

- Test new data releases and documentation before launch by flagging incorrect coding, unclear documentation, and issues with data tools.
- Develop documentation, sample code, and training exercises for analyses and hypothesis testing of survey data.

Special Project: Occupational Standing (Nam-Powers-Boyd) Update

- Collaborated with researchers at Florida State University to review and correct IPUMS processing of Nam-Powers-Boyd occupational status variables, tracing discrepancies across Python, Stata, SPSS, and Excel.

Graduate Researcher

September 2019 – May 2021

Marin Bozic, Department of Applied Economics, University of Minnesota

- Built and maintained Excel decision tools used by dairy producers to (1) forecast and backtest indemnity payouts under the USDA Dairy Margin Coverage program, (2) compare current daily commodity milk prices, and (3) calculate expected indemnities under Dairy Revenue Protection.
- Trained analysts at Land O'Lakes to use the expected-indemnity tool.
- Translated, defined, and categorized commodity metadata from national statistical offices and U.S. trade data, and loaded it into a University of Minnesota agricultural products database using Microsoft Visual Studio.

TEACHING

Adjunct Instructor, University of St. Thomas, St. Paul, MN

May 2021 – Jan 2022

Principles of Microeconomics (ECON 252)

- Designed the course, including syllabus, lectures, assignments, and exams, for a semester class of 50 students.
- Taught an accelerated summer section with asynchronous lectures and an in-person fall section; graded all coursework and held office hours.

Graduate Teaching Assistant, University of Minnesota – Twin Cities

Sep 2020 – May 2021

APEC 4481/5481: Futures and Options Markets (Spring 2021); APEC 3501: Agribusiness Finance (Fall 2020)

- Graded homework, exams, projects, and participation for classes of about 30 students each; maintained course websites and held weekly online office hours.

LEADERSHIP AND SERVICE

President, Applied Economics Graduate Club, University of Minnesota

Sep 2021 – Aug 2024

- Organized and led meetings with student members of departmental committees to discuss proposed program changes and additional student support, and to gather student input on future initiatives.
- Coordinated with the department and delegated tasks to organize department events, including the annual welcome picnic and International Dinner.

SKILLS

Programming: Stata, R, Python, SAS, SPSS, Excel, IPUMS API (ipumspy), Git/GitHub, LaTeX; familiarity with ArcGIS and MATLAB

Methods: Survey-weighted analysis and complex survey design; causal inference (shift-share instrumental variables, difference-in-differences); data quality review and documentation

Data: IPUMS USA (ACS, decennial census), CPS ASEC, IPUMS International census samples, DHS, expenditure data